

3.2.10 The image disappears and reappears randomly

Cause: This most probably points to an electrical fault.

Solution: Check all the cable connections as well as the video card. The electrical fault may be internal to the monitor; get it checked at a repair shop.

3.3 Troubleshooting the Video Card / Memory / Driver / BIOS

3.3.1 The screen flickers, causing eye strain and fatigue

Cause: The computer ‘paints’ the screen with the image several times a second—this is known as the refresh rate. If the refresh rate is set too low, it can cause visible flicker, which can be a strain on the eyes.

Solution: Right-click on the Desktop, select Properties, go to Settings > Advanced, and look for the Refresh Rate option in the Properties window for the display adapter that launches. Increase the refresh rate to the maximum supported level. Note that setting the refresh rate too high can cause blank screens—you’ll then have to revert to the old setting.

3.3.2 The image is scrambled or jumping, or there are diagonal lines

Cause: The display controls could have ‘pushed’ the image off-screen. It may also be a problem with the refresh rate or the resolution being set too high.

Read This First

Many problems with video (graphics, display, etc.) cards, and general Windows stability, can be due to incorrect software drivers. Before looking anywhere else, ensure that you have the correct drivers for your video card. This will save you many hours of needless frustration. If your card is onboard and part of the motherboard chipset you can visit the motherboard manufacturer’s Web site to download the latest updates for the video drivers, or get it from the motherboard CD. If you have an add-on card, get the latest updates from the card manufacturer’s Web site or the CD that came with the card.